The Week Ahead
Forecasts, data preview, central bank watch

30 October 2026

KEY DATA RELEASES AND EVENTS NEXT WEEK

- BNM is expected to hold the policy rate unchanged at 2.75%.
- Hong Kong's GDP likely rose by 2.6% in 3Q.
- South Korea's export growth is projected to accelerate in October.



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We cover the key data releases and central bank events of the coming week, collating our macro forecasts.

KEY FORECAST FOR THE COMING WEEK

Event	DBS	Previous
Nov 1 (Sun)		
South Korea: exports (Oct)	103.2% y/y	83.7% y/y
- imports	45.7% y/y	26.0% y/y
- trade balance	USD43.0bn	USD50.0bn
Nov 2 (Mon)		
Indonesia: GDP (3Q)	5.2% y/y	5.3% y/y
- exports (Sep)	5.4% y/y	6.7% y/y
- imports	17.3% y/y	19.1% y/y
- trade balance	USD2.0bn	USD3.55bn
- CPI	3.4% y/y	3.3% y/y
Nov 3 (Tue)		
Hong Kong: GDP (3Q)	2.6% y/y	4.3% y/y
- retail sales (Sep)	4.7% y/y	5.6% y/y
South Korea: CPI (Oct)	2.9% y/y	2.9% y/y
Vietnam: exports (Oct)	42.0% y/y	39.1% y/y
- imports	46.5% y/y	45.8% y/y
- trade balance	USD1.9bn	USD1.3bn
- retail sales YoY YTD (Oct)	14.0% y/y	13.4% y/y
Vietnam: CPI (Oct)	5.1% y/y	5.1% y/y
Nov 4 (Wed)		
Eurozone: CPI (Oct)	4.2% y/y	3.8% y/y
Nov 5 (Thu)		
Malaysia: BNM overnight policy rate	2.75%	2.75%
Taiwan: CPI (Oct)	2.3% y/y	2.7% y/y
Thailand: CPI (Oct)	3.2% y/y	2.8% y/y
Philippines: CPI (Oct)	7.9% y/y	7.2% y/y
Nov 6 (Fri)		
US: change in nonfarm payrolls (Oct)	100k	29k

CENTRAL BANK MEETINGS

Bank Negara Malaysia (BNM) (5 November)

As written in our Macro Strategy note, BNM's final meeting of 2026 on 5 November will be live and a close call, after the central bank opened the door to monetary policy normalisation during its September review. BNM Governor Abdul Rasheed Ghaffour reiterated in a Bloomberg interview on 15 October that the central bank has space to adjust policy if needed, as policymakers are vigilant about upside inflationary pressures amid strong economic growth. He also said that policy decisions will be data dependent. We think the latest available September data for the upcoming meeting suggest that policymakers can afford to be patient until 1H27, maintaining the Overnight Policy Rate at 2.75% for now. Inflation remained contained within the lower half of the official 2026 inflation forecast range of 1.5-2.5%, notwithstanding external price pressures and robust economic activity. Advance estimates showed GDP growth of 5.3% yoy in 3Q26, while exports jumped to a five-year high of 54.5% yoy in September, supercharged by the artificial intelligence boom. However, headline inflation eased slightly to 1.8% yoy in September 2026 from 1.9% yoy in August, while core inflation remained stable at 1.7% yoy. Fuel subsidies have limited the pass-through of upstream cost pressures to consumer prices, alongside stable domestic demand conditions.

FORTHCOMING DATA RELEASES

South Korea

October trade and inflation data are due for release. Export growth is expected to accelerate to nearly 100% yoy, up from 83.7% in September, while the trade surplus is forecast to remain above USD40bn for another month. CPI inflation is expected to hold steady at 2.9% yoy. Overall, the data should reinforce the view that AI- and semiconductor-driven growth and the expansion in South Korea's trade surplus remain firmly on track, providing fundamental support for the KOSPI and KRW. Meanwhile, inflation remains sticky above the BOK's 2% target, bolstering the case for further monetary tightening as early as the November policy meeting.

Taiwan

October inflation data are forthcoming. Headline CPI inflation is expected to remain above 2% for the sixth consecutive month, at 2.3% yoy. Core CPI inflation is also likely to stay above 2% for the sixth consecutive month, at 2.3% yoy. Despite government subsidies on fuel and electricity prices, higher global energy prices continue to feed through to CPI via items such as airfares and tour package fees. Services inflation also remains sticky, particularly in food away from home, housing, transportation, and entertainment. Meanwhile, domestic inflation expectations appear to be gradually rising. A recent private-sector survey showed that the public expects

inflation to average 2.5% in 2026, with 52% of respondents expecting inflation to exceed 2.5%. Against this backdrop, we maintain our view that the central bank will resume rate hikes in December, raising the policy rate by 12.5 bps to 2.125%.

Thailand

We expect Thailand's headline inflation to rise to 3.2% yoy in October 2026, extending the increase over the previous two months, and moving slightly above the upper end of the Bank of Thailand's 1-3% target range. This was likely driven by faster energy inflation amid an uptrend in diesel prices, alongside a rebound in food inflation. The inflation uptrend was likely broadly in line with the central bank's expectations and mainly supply-side driven, supporting its decision to look through the temporary price pressures and keep its policy rate unchanged at its October meeting.

Vietnam

We expect Vietnam's October 2026 goods exports and retail sales to remain robust at 42.0% yoy and 14.0% yoy year-to-date, respectively, while headline inflation is likely to stay elevated at around 5.0% yoy. Exports have continued to be supported by strong electronics and machinery shipments amid a favourable technology cycle with spillovers from robust artificial intelligence-related demand. Retail sales were likely bolstered by firm household spending, supported by favourable labour market conditions, and continued strength in tourism. Headline inflation has remained elevated and above the central bank's target of 4.5% for the year, driven by price pressures from transport and energy, food, as well as material costs. This poses a challenge for policymakers as they seek to balance inflation risks against ambitions of achieving at least 10% economic growth this year.

Hong Kong

Hong Kong's economy is expected to decelerate from 4.3% yoy in Q2 to 2.6% in Q3, largely due to slower private consumption. Despite a 13% increase in Mainland visitor arrivals during the period, domestic consumption continued to be weighed down by a weakening labour market, with the unemployment rate elevated at 3.9% in September. Meanwhile, higher interest rates have dampened investment sentiment and capital market activity. The Centa-City Leading Index remained broadly flat, while the Hang Seng Index was range-bound at around 25,000. The positive wealth effect seen in 1H has faded as asset market performance remained muted. A strong HKD continued to encourage outbound tourism, evidenced by an increase in average daily resident departures from 6.9% yoy in Q2 to 10.9% in Q3.

However, GDP growth is expected to be buffered by improving net exports amid the ongoing AI-electronics upcycle. Export growth picked up and outpaced import growth during Q3. Hong Kong, as China's free port and re-export hub, is benefiting from stronger demand for Chinese electronic goods.

Indonesia/ Philippines

Indonesia's 3Q GDP likely moderated to 5.2% y/y. Soft consumer confidence and retail sales growth point to weaker consumption, compounded by a gradual rise in inflation. Fiscal measures likely helped spending among low-income households. Despite the quarterly moderation, we maintain our full-year growth forecast at 5.3% y/y.

Inflation rates in Indonesia and the Philippines are expected to rise, albeit to different degrees. Indonesia's inflation is on course to edge up modestly, while in the Philippines, stronger pass-through from higher oil prices, food and transportation costs, as well as imported inflation pressures stemming from a weaker peso, is likely to push inflation to a multi-year high.

GROWTH, INFLATION, POLICY RATES & FX FORECASTS

	GDP GROWTH, % YOY				CPI INFLATION, % YOY			
	2025	2026f	2027f	2028f	2025	2026f	2027f	2028f
CHINA	5.0	5.0	4.5	4.3	0.2	0.0	1.0	1.0
HONG KONG	2.5	3.5	3.8	2.8	1.5	1.4	2.0	2.0
INDIA	7.4	7.3	7.8	7.0	4.9	2.2	4.6	5.0
INDIA (FISCAL YEAR) *	7.2	7.8	7.3	7.0	4.6	2.1	5.3	4.7
INDONESIA	5.0	5.1	5.3	5.2	2.3	1.9	3.3	2.5
MALAYSIA	5.2	5.2	5.2	4.5	1.8	1.4	2.0	2.0
PHILIPPINES**	5.6	4.5	3.0	4.0	3.2	1.7	6.5	5.5
SINGAPORE	5.3	5.0	5.7	3.5	2.4	0.9	2.0	1.8
SOUTH KOREA	2.0	1.0	3.8	2.9	2.3	2.1	2.6	2.7
TAIWAN	5.3	8.8	11.6	5.6	2.2	1.7	2.0	2.1
THAILAND	2.9	2.4	2.1	2.0	0.4	-0.1	1.7	1.0
VIETNAM	7.0	8.0	9.1	8.0	3.6	3.3	4.8	3.3
EUROZONE	0.7	1.5	1.2	1.2	2.3	2.2	3.1	2.1
JAPAN	0.1	1.2	0.9	1.0	2.7	3.2	1.8	1.5
UNITED STATES***	2.8	2.1	2.3	2.2	3.0	2.7	3.3	2.8

** 2020 = Fiscal year Apr20-Mar21 ** new CPI series *** eop for CPI inflation*

POLICY INTEREST RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
CHINA*	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
INDIA	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.75	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00
INDONESIA	4.75	5.75	5.75	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00
MALAYSIA	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
PHILIPPINES	4.25	4.75	5.00	5.75	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00
SINGAPORE**	1.16	1.16	1.55	1.80	2.00	2.00	2.00	1.90
SOUTH KOREA	2.50	2.50	3.00	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
TAIWAN	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13
THAILAND	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
VIETNAM***	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50
EUROZONE^	2.00	2.25	2.50	2.75	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
JAPAN	0.75	1.00	1.25	1.25	1.50	1.75	1.75	1.75
UNITED STATES	3.75	3.75	4.00	4.25	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50

EXCHANGE RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
USD/CNY	6.89	6.79	6.69	6.60	6.63	6.65	6.68	6.70
USD/HKD	7.84	7.84	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83
USD/INR	94.8	94.7	95.8	95.6	95.7	95.8	95.9	96.0
USD/IDR	17041	17907	17720	17400	17470	17530	17600	17660
USD/MYR	4.05	4.08	4.07	4.00	4.04	4.08	4.11	4.15
USD/PHP	60.7	61.3	62.6	61.5	62.1	62.8	63.4	64.0
USD/SGD	1.29	1.29	1.28	1.26	1.27	1.27	1.28	1.29
USD/KRW	1516	1549	1395	1400	1410	1420	1425	1435
USD/THB	32.6	33.2	33.3	32.6	32.8	32.9	33.0	33.2
USD/VND	26340	26310	26000	25840	25980	26120	26260	26400
AUD/USD	0.69	0.69	0.71	0.71	0.71	0.70	0.70	0.70
USD/CAD	1.16	1.14	1.15	1.18	1.17	1.17	1.16	1.15
EUR/USD	159	163	156	151	153	154	155	157
USD/JPY	1.32	1.33	1.34	1.36	1.35	1.34	1.33	1.32
NZD/USD	6.89	6.79	6.69	6.60	6.63	6.65	6.68	6.70
USD/CHF	7.84	7.84	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83
GBP/USD	94.8	94.7	95.8	95.6	95.7	95.8	95.9	96.0

INTEREST RATE FORECASTS

		2027				2028			
		Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
US	3M SOFR OIS	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.25	4.15	3.90	3.90	3.90
	2Y	4.70	4.70	4.70	4.70	4.30	4.15	4.15	4.15
	10Y	5.20	5.20	5.20	5.20	5.00	4.75	4.75	4.75
	10Y-2Y	50	50	50	50	70	60	60	60
Japan	3M TIBOR	1.75	1.85	1.85	1.85	1.85	1.85	1.85	1.85
	2Y	1.85	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95
	10Y	2.95	3.00	3.00	3.00	2.90	2.80	2.70	2.60
	10Y-2Y	110	105	105	105	95	85	75	65
Europe	3M EURIBOR	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.10	2.90	2.70
	2Y	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.10	3.00	2.90	2.80
	10Y	3.50	3.60	3.70	3.80	3.65	3.50	3.35	3.20
	10Y-2Y	30	40	50	60	55	50	45	40
Indonesia	3M JIBOR	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	5.70	5.50
	2Y	7.00	6.90	6.90	6.80	6.70	6.60	6.30	6.20
	10Y	7.50	7.40	7.40	7.30	7.20	7.20	7.00	7.00
	10Y-2Y	50	50	50	50	50	60	70	80
Malaysia	3M KLIBOR	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35
	3Y	3.30	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
	10Y	3.85	3.85	3.80	3.80	3.70	3.70	3.70	3.70
	10Y-3Y	55	60	55	55	45	45	45	45
Philippines	3M PHP ref rate	6.20	6.20	6.20	6.20	6.20	6.20	6.20	6.20
	2Y	7.05	7.05	7.10	7.10	7.10	7.10	7.10	7.10
	10Y	8.15	8.15	8.20	8.20	8.20	8.20	8.20	8.20
	10Y-2Y	110	110	110	110	110	110	110	110
Singapore	3M SORA OIS	2.00	2.00	2.00	1.90	1.80	1.60	1.60	1.60
	2Y	2.20	2.20	2.20	2.20	2.00	1.80	1.80	1.80
	10Y	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.55	2.40	2.40	2.40
	10Y-2Y	50	50	50	50	55	60	60	60
Thailand	3M BIBOR	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.40	1.65
	2Y	1.25	1.30	1.35	1.35	1.35	1.55	1.65	1.75
	10Y	2.30	2.40	2.50	2.60	2.60	2.70	2.80	2.90
	10Y-2Y	105	110	115	125	125	115	115	115
China	1Y LPR	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
	2Y	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25
	10Y	1.80	1.80	1.80	1.80	1.80	1.80	1.80	1.80
	10Y-2Y	55	55	55	55	55	55	55	55
Hong Kong, SAR	3M HIBOR	3.60	3.60	3.60	3.45	3.35	3.10	3.10	3.10
	2Y*	4.20	4.20	4.20	4.20	3.80	3.65	3.65	3.65
	10Y*	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.20	3.95	3.95	3.95
	10Y-2Y	20	20	20	20	40	30	30	30
Korea	3M CD	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.25	3.25
	3Y	3.90	3.90	3.90	3.90	3.90	3.90	3.70	3.70
	10Y	4.35	4.35	4.35	4.35	4.30	4.30	4.10	4.10
	10Y-3Y	45	45	45	45	40	40	40	40
India	3M MIBOR	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.70	6.50
	2Y	7.15	7.15	7.15	7.15	7.15	6.90	6.80	6.70
	10Y	7.60	7.60	7.60	7.60	7.60	7.50	7.40	7.40
	10Y-2Y	45	45	45	45	45	60	60	70

%, eop, govt bond yield for 2Y and 10Y, spread bps

Sources: Data for all charts and tables are from CEIC, Bloomberg and DBS Group Research (forecasts and transformations)

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The Week Ahead
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23 October 2026

KEY DATA RELEASES AND EVENTS NEXT WEEK

- G3 central banks expected to pause
- BOT also expected to hold rates
- South Korea and Taiwan GDP releases to reaffirm AI-driven demand momentum



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We cover the key data releases and central bank events of the coming week, collating our macro forecasts.

KEY FORECAST FOR THE COMING WEEK

Event	DBS	Previous
Oct 26 (Mon)		
Singapore: industrial production (Sep)	7.6% y/y	15.4% y/y
Oct 27 (Tue)		
South Korea: GDP (3Q)	3.2% y/y	3.7% y/y
Oct 28 (Wed)		
BOT benchmark rate	1.00%	1.00%
Hong Kong: exports (Sep)	55.1% y/y	53% y/y
- imports	49.8% y/y	60% y/y
- trade balance	-HKD50.8bn	-HKD71.2bn
India: industrial production (Sep)	5.3% y/y	8.0% y/y
Oct 29 (Thu)		
FOMC rate decision	4.00%	4.00%
US: GDP (3Q)	2.2% q/q saar	2.2% q/q saar
ECB deposit facility rate	2.50%	2.50%
Oct 30 (Fri)		
South Korea: industrial production (Sep)	0.6% y/y	-2.2% y/y
Japan: industrial production (Sep)	1.9% y/y	2.7% y/y
Philippines: exports (Sep)	26% y/y	27.8% y/y
- imports	7% y/y	16.6% y/y
- trade balance	-USD3587mn	-USD3850mn
Taiwan: GDP (3Q)	12.9% y/y	12.9% y/y
Eurozone: GDP (3Q)	0.4% q/q sa	0.6% q/q sa
BOJ target rate	1.25%	1.25%

CENTRAL BANK MEETINGS

Bank of Thailand (BOT) (October 28)

We expect the BOT to maintain its policy rate at 1.00% at its 28 October meeting, extending its pause for a fourth consecutive decision as it balances inflationary pressures against uneven and subdued economic growth. Our view is aligned with fixed market income pricing. Headline inflation rose anew to 2.8% yoy in September 2026, driven by higher energy, food, and core price increases, but remained within the upper end of the central bank's 1-3% target range. As the BOT is still likely to look through what it views as temporary, supply-driven inflationary pressures, it will likely refrain from tightening policy, and keep interest rates accommodative to support the soft and uneven growth cycle.

European Central Bank (October 29)

We expect the ECB to extend its pause, keeping the deposit facility rate at 2.5%. Market participants will instead focus on the central bank's assessment of rising French and Italian bond yields and widening spreads versus Bunds. While we do not expect direct references to individual countries, the ECB is likely to signal that recent developments in France reflect the country's weaker fiscal and debt profile rather than a broader systemic concern. Policymakers will seek to differentiate between a localised bond sell-off and a Eurozone-wide market disruption, justifying their decision to monitor developments rather than implement specific measures at this juncture. Meanwhile, inflation continues to rise, with little relief expected in upcoming readings given elevated global fuel prices.

Bank of Japan (October 30)

The Bank of Japan is expected to keep the overnight call rate unchanged at 1.25% at this meeting, pausing after the 25bp hike in September. The BOJ is likely to assess the impact of the previous rate hike before taking further action. The recent stabilisation of the yen also reduces the urgency of another hike at this meeting.

The tightening bias should remain intact. Growth and inflation remain broadly on track, leaving room for the BOJ to revise up its FY2026–FY2027 GDP and CPI forecasts. Wage growth has also remained strong, with Rengo reportedly targeting wage increases of 6% in 2027, reinforcing the BOJ's confidence that underlying inflation can be sustained around its 2% target. We continue to expect the policy rate to rise to 1.50% in December 2026 or January 2027, followed by a further increase to 1.75% by 2Q 2027.

FORTHCOMING DATA RELEASES

Hong Kong SAR

Export growth is expected to accelerate from 53.0% yoy in August to 55.0% in September, in line with the pickup in China's export growth from 25.0% to 36.3%. As a key re-export hub for China,

Hong Kong should benefit from robust AI-related electronics trade, with electrical machinery, equipment and parts exports to Hong Kong accounting for 20.6% of China's total exports. Import growth is also expected to remain firm, supported by resilient export orders and gradually improving investment sentiment, sustaining demand for intermediate and capital goods.

Singapore

Singapore's industrial production (IP) likely remained in expansion for a 13th consecutive month in September 2026, although we expect growth to moderate to 7.6% yoy from August's strong 15.4% yoy pace. IP growth continued to be underpinned by the electronics and precision engineering clusters, which has been key drivers of Singapore's manufacturing strength, reflecting sustained demand for artificial intelligence-related hardware. However, performance across clusters remained uneven, with chemicals and biomedical manufacturing likely contracting, and tempering overall gains.

South Korea

The preliminary estimate for 3Q26 GDP is likely to show growth remaining solid at 3.2% yoy, slightly below 3.7% in 2Q and 3.8% in 1Q. Nominal GDP growth is likely to remain in double digits, significantly outpacing real GDP growth, thanks to improved terms of trade amid rising memory export prices. By expenditure, exports picked up in 3Q in both nominal and real terms, supported by stronger semiconductor shipments. Investment also appeared robust, as reflected in the equipment investment estimation index and machinery order index. Private consumption, however, appeared to weaken amid the sharp KOSPI correction since July following the introduction of leveraged ETF regulations. Our full-year GDP growth forecasts of 3.5% for 2026 and 2.4% for 2027 remain on track.

Taiwan

The preliminary estimate for 3Q GDP is likely to show growth remaining strong at 12–13% yoy, close to 12.9% in 2Q, albeit below the peak of 15.4% in 1Q. Exports maintained strong double-digit growth in 3Q (44.6% yoy in nominal terms and 21.1% in real terms), supported by robust shipments of semiconductors, servers and other AI-related products. Machinery investment also sustained strong double-digit growth, underpinned by higher capacity utilisation in the ICT sector and a resulting increase in capital goods imports. Private consumption appeared to have strengthened further, supported by stock market gains, improving wage growth, and the associated wealth and income effects. Construction investment remained the weak spot, weighed down by elevated inventories in the new-home market and the ongoing need for inventory digestion. We maintain our 2026 and 2027 GDP growth forecasts at 11.6% and 5.6%, respectively, with risks tilted to the upside.

GROWTH, INFLATION, POLICY RATES & FX FORECASTS

	GDP GROWTH, % YOY				CPI INFLATION, % YOY			
	2025	2026f	2027f	2028f	2025	2026f	2027f	2028f
CHINA	5.0	4.5	4.3	4.0	0.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
HONG KONG	3.5	3.8	2.8	2.5	1.4	2.0	2.0	2.0
INDIA	7.3	7.8	7.0	6.8	2.2	4.6	5.0	4.2
*INDIA (FISCAL YEAR) **	*7.8*	*7.3*	*7.0*	*6.8*	*2.1*	*5.3*	*4.7*	4.5
INDONESIA	5.1	5.3	5.2	5.2	1.9	3.3	2.5	2.2
MALAYSIA	5.2	5.2	4.5	4.3	1.4	2.0	2.0	2.0
PHILIPPINES**	4.5	3.0	4.0	4.5	1.7	6.5	5.5	3.5
SINGAPORE	5.0	5.7	3.5	2.8	0.9	2.0	1.8	1.6
SOUTH KOREA	1.0	3.5	2.4	2.0	2.1	2.6	2.7	2.7
TAIWAN	8.8	11.6	5.6	3.8	1.7	2.0	2.1	1.9
THAILAND	2.4	2.1	2.0	2.2	-0.1	1.7	1.0	1.2
VIETNAM	8.0	9.1	8.0	7.2	3.3	4.8	3.3	3.0
EUROZONE	1.5	1.2	1.2	0.9	2.2	3.1	2.1	2.0
JAPAN	1.2	0.9	1.0	0.9	3.2	1.8	1.5	2.0
UNITED STATES***	2.1	2.3	2.2	2.0	2.7	3.3	2.8	2.4

** 2020 = Fiscal year Apr20-Mar21 ** new CPI series *** eop for CPI inflation*

POLICY INTEREST RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
CHINA*	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
INDIA	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.75	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00
INDONESIA	4.75	5.75	5.75	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00
MALAYSIA	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
PHILIPPINES	4.25	4.75	5.00	5.75	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00
SINGAPORE**	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.80	2.00	2.00	2.00	1.90
SOUTH KOREA	2.50	2.50	3.00	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
TAIWAN	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13
THAILAND	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
VIETNAM***	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50
EUROZONE^	2.00	2.25	2.50	2.75	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
JAPAN	0.75	1.00	1.25	1.25	1.50	1.75	1.75	1.75
UNITED STATES	3.75	3.75	4.00	4.25	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50

EXCHANGE RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
USD/CNY	6.89	6.79	6.71	6.60	6.63	6.65	6.68	6.70
USD/HKD	7.84	7.84	7.85	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83
USD/INR	94.8	94.7	95.8	95.6	95.7	95.6	95.5	95.4
USD/IDR	17041	17907	17894	17400	17470	17530	17600	17660
USD/MYR	4.05	4.08	4.08	4.00	4.04	4.08	4.11	4.15
USD/PHP	60.7	61.3	62.7	61.5	62.1	62.8	63.4	64.0
USD/SGD	1.29	1.29	1.28	1.26	1.27	1.27	1.28	1.29
USD/KRW	1516	1549	1358	1400	1410	1420	1425	1435
USD/THB	32.6	33.2	33.6	32.6	32.8	32.9	33.0	33.2
USD/VND	26340	26310	25964	25840	25980	26120	26260	26400
AUD/USD	0.69	0.69	0.69	0.71	0.71	0.70	0.70	0.70
USD/CAD	1.39	1.42	1.42	1.37	1.38	1.39	1.40	1.40
EUR/USD	1.16	1.14	1.13	1.18	1.17	1.17	1.16	1.15
USD/JPY	158.7	162.6	157.4	151.0	153.0	154.0	155.0	157.0
NZD/USD	0.57	0.57	0.56	0.59	0.59	0.58	0.58	0.57
USD/CHF	0.80	0.81	0.84	0.81	0.82	0.83	0.83	0.84
GBP/USD	1.32	1.33	1.33	1.36	1.35	1.34	1.33	1.32
DXY INDEX	100.0	101.2	101.5	97.6	98.3	99.0	99.7	100.4

INTEREST RATE FORECASTS

		2027				2028			
		Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
US	3M SOFR OIS	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.25	4.15	3.90	3.90	3.90
	2Y	4.70	4.70	4.70	4.70	4.30	4.15	4.15	4.15
	10Y	5.20	5.20	5.20	5.20	5.00	4.75	4.75	4.75
	10Y-2Y	50	50	50	50	70	60	60	60
Japan	3M TIBOR	1.75	1.85	1.85	1.85	1.85	1.85	1.85	1.85
	2Y	1.85	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95
	10Y	2.95	3.00	3.00	3.00	2.90	2.80	2.70	2.60
	10Y-2Y	110	105	105	105	95	85	75	65
Europe	3M EURIBOR	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.10	2.90	2.70
	2Y	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.10	3.00	2.90	2.80
	10Y	3.50	3.60	3.70	3.80	3.65	3.50	3.35	3.20
	10Y-2Y	30	40	50	60	55	50	45	40
Indonesia	3M JIBOR	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	5.70	5.50
	2Y	7.00	6.90	6.90	6.80	6.70	6.60	6.30	6.20
	10Y	7.50	7.40	7.40	7.30	7.20	7.20	7.00	7.00
	10Y-2Y	50	50	50	50	50	60	70	80
Malaysia	3M KLIBOR	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35
	3Y	3.30	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
	10Y	3.85	3.85	3.80	3.80	3.70	3.70	3.70	3.70
	10Y-3Y	55	60	55	55	45	45	45	45
Philippines	3M PHP ref rate	6.20	6.20	6.20	6.20	6.20	6.20	6.20	6.20
	2Y	7.05	7.05	7.10	7.10	7.10	7.10	7.10	7.10
	10Y	8.15	8.15	8.20	8.20	8.20	8.20	8.20	8.20
	10Y-2Y	110	110	110	110	110	110	110	110
Singapore	3M SORA OIS	2.00	2.00	2.00	1.90	1.80	1.60	1.60	1.60
	2Y	2.20	2.20	2.20	2.20	2.00	1.80	1.80	1.80
	10Y	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.55	2.40	2.40	2.40
	10Y-2Y	50	50	50	50	55	60	60	60
Thailand	3M BIBOR	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.40	1.65
	2Y	1.25	1.30	1.35	1.35	1.35	1.55	1.65	1.75
	10Y	2.30	2.40	2.50	2.60	2.60	2.70	2.80	2.90
	10Y-2Y	105	110	115	125	125	115	115	115
China	1Y LPR	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
	2Y	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25
	10Y	1.80	1.80	1.80	1.80	1.80	1.80	1.80	1.80
	10Y-2Y	55	55	55	55	55	55	55	55
Hong Kong, SAR	3M HIBOR	3.60	3.60	3.60	3.45	3.35	3.10	3.10	3.10
	2Y*	4.20	4.20	4.20	4.20	3.80	3.65	3.65	3.65
	10Y*	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.20	3.95	3.95	3.95
	10Y-2Y	20	20	20	20	40	30	30	30
Korea	3M CD	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.25	3.25
	3Y	3.90	3.90	3.90	3.90	3.90	3.90	3.70	3.70
	10Y	4.35	4.35	4.35	4.35	4.30	4.30	4.10	4.10
	10Y-3Y	45	45	45	45	40	40	40	40
India	3M MIBOR	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.70	6.50
	2Y	7.15	7.15	7.15	7.15	7.15	6.90	6.80	6.70
	10Y	7.60	7.60	7.60	7.60	7.60	7.50	7.40	7.40
	10Y-2Y	45	45	45	45	45	60	60	70

%, eop, govt bond yield for 2Y and 10Y, spread bps

Sources: Data for all charts and tables are from CEIC, Bloomberg and DBS Group Research (forecasts and transformations)

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DBS Flash

India: Degrees of rupee defence

16 October 2026

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- *The RBI has adopted a multi-layered defence strategy to support the rupee this year.*
- *Parallels with 2013 exist, although the circumstances differ.*
- *Rupee gains have been accompanied with distortions elsewhere.*
- *Authorities are likely not done and remain ready to take further action, if needed.*
- *Scope of further rate increases is high. Not a panacea but a necessary step.*
- *If FX depreciation pressures return, a larger scale of hike or inter-meeting move might also be considered.*

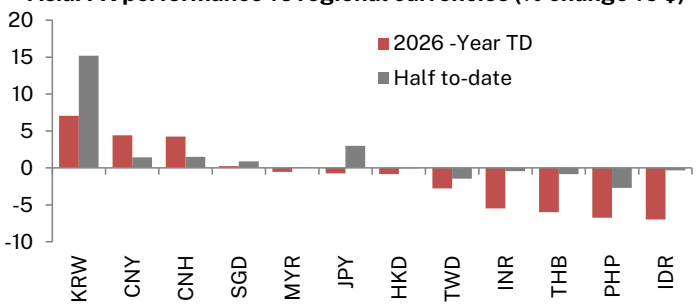
TAKING STOCK

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has adopted a multi-layered defence strategy to support the rupee this year.

This has entailed a combination of outright intervention in spot/ forwards, regulatory action, liquidity steps, administrative measures and moves to curb import-related dollar demand.

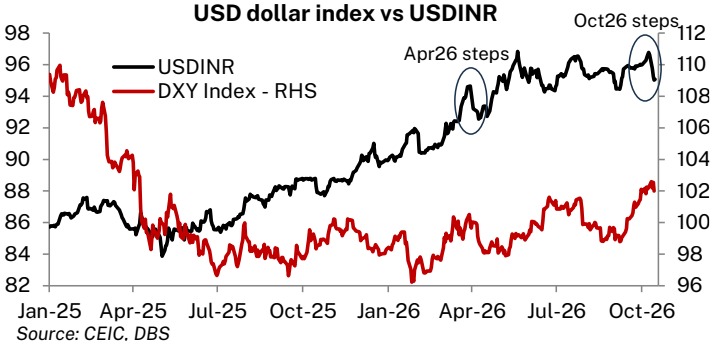
The rupee has appreciated by 1.8% against the dollar in the past five days since recent measures took effect, paring YTD depreciation to 5.5%. High oil prices, weakness in capital inflows, a firm dollar, tariffs/ geopolitical worries, energy, and risk-off sentiments have kept the INR under pressure since last year.

Asia: FX performance vs regional currencies (% change vs $)



Source: Bloomberg, DBS; as of 15-Oct

USD dollar index vs USDINR



Source: CEIC, DBS

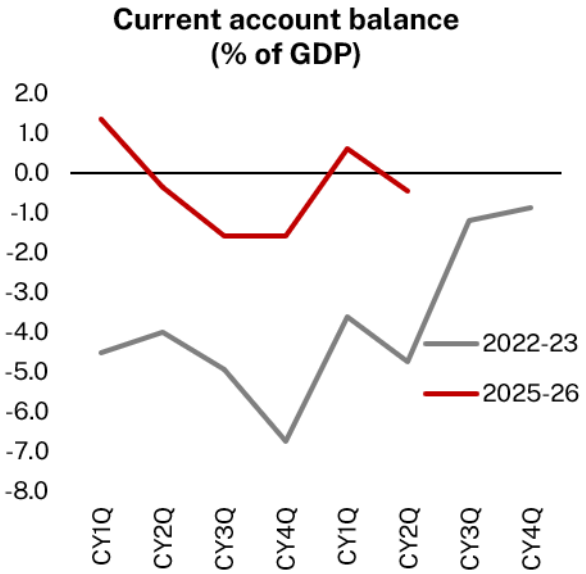
ECHOES OF 2013 WITH FEW DIFFERENCES

Comparisons with 2013 are apt, though the backdrop differs. As for the catalysts, markets reacted to the US Fed's taper announcement in 2013, which pushed US yields higher and led global investors to reduce exposure to vulnerable EM economies. As a result, capital inflows weakened, exposing funding mismatches for countries, including India, that were running wide current account deficits.

In 2026, markets face the spectre of elevated oil prices, geopolitical uncertainty, global competition for capital, a firm dollar (DXY appreciated +3.8% YTD), and US inflation/ deficits which have settled at levels much higher than pre-pandemic years. This has pushed up UST yields, and the US Fed kicked off its rate-hike cycle in Sep26.

Against this backdrop, **the RBI is pursuing the same objective, i.e., to ensure rupee stability, but the nature of the battle differs.** The defence strategy has shifted from 'crisis management' mode in 2013, due to weaker domestic macroeconomic balances (a wide current account gap, high inflation, a lower reserve buffer, and wide fiscal deficits), to a 'terms-of-trade shock and impact of a firm dollar' in 2026.

Flashpoints are nonetheless similar, with reliance on portfolio financing, leaving the external account vulnerable to shifts in global risk sentiment. Portfolio outflows have emerged as the primary transmission channel through which external shocks have translated into INR depreciation pressure, compounded by high energy prices and a firm dollar.



Source: CEIC, DBS

FX PLAYBOOK

While the response framework is similar between 2013 and this year, the broad sequence and nature of macroprudential measures differ. **This year's multi-layered rupee defence toolkit has included:**

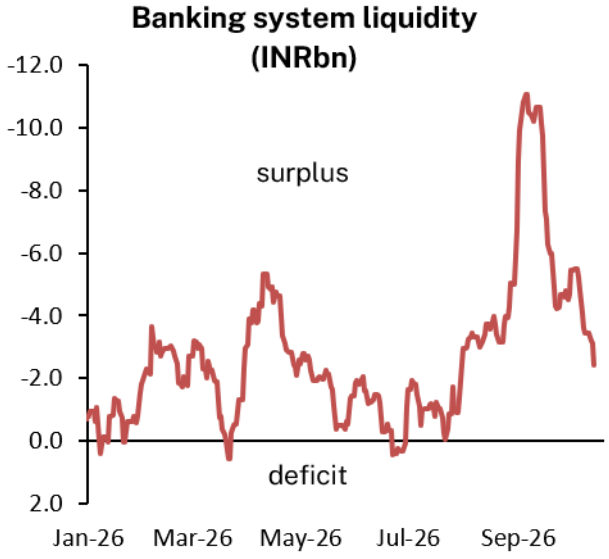
-***Direct FX defence*** by way of intervention in the spot and forwards market. As of Aug26, the net forward dollar liabilities ballooned to $200bn, rising by ~$63bn vs. the month before. Recent sell/buy FX swaps are expected to lower this stock in the coming months.

-***Attracting dollar inflows*** by way of special swap facilities for FCNR deposits, and offshore borrowings, apart from liberalising taxes around debt inflows,

amongst others. We discussed this here, here, here and here.

Taking a proactive stance, a portion of existing FX reserves could be earmarked against forward liabilities (from maturing FCNR deposits), helping to mitigate concerns that deposit maturities or debt repayments could trigger a sharp increase in dollar demand down the line.

-***Domestic liquidity management***. Bonds, to some degree, are paying the price for the authorities' efforts to defend the rupee against the additional headwind of weak global conditions. INR liquidity surged on the back of the swap windows, prompting the RBI to undertake open market operations, VRRR auctions, sell-buy swaps, among others. While these have been effective in absorbing balances, bond yields have drifted higher. 10Y yields are at three-year highs and are expected to climb further (DBSf: 7.40-7.50% by year-end).



Source: Bloomberg, DBS

-***Moderate FX demand and speculation***. Earlier in the year, the RBI had introduced changes to the banks' net open position framework, and thereafter partially rolled back a few curbs. Prudential measures on FX exposures and hedging-related measures were announced in Oct26, which included the introduction of a daily cash reserve with the RBI equal to 20% of the rupee equivalent of the notional value for INR-linked derivative contracts exceeding $2mn used to hedge current account transactions, referred to as the Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve (FERR). Subsequent clarifications provided operational details on where the FERR would be maintained and that it would be subject to audits.

Since 12 Oct, the RBI has been providing dollars via designated banks to the three state-owned oil-marketing companies (Indian Oil, BPCL, and HPCL) to meet the their daily dollar requirements, thereby diverting related spot-market demand.

On hedging-related matters, the limit for undertaking foreign exchange derivative transactions without proving an underlying commercial exposure was cut to $5mn from $100mn across all ADs and exchange-traded currency derivatives. Restrictions on Rebooking, i.e., authorized dealers are prohibited from allowing customers to rebook cancelled rupee-linked derivative contracts (though rollovers upon maturity remain permitted). Lastly, banks must obtain written confirmation from users that the same underlying exposure has not been hedged with another dealer. Data from CCI, cited by

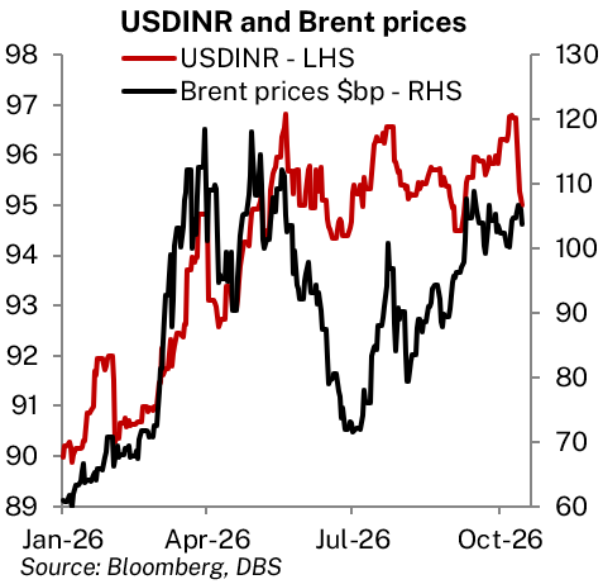
Bloomberg, pointed to importers' forward dollar purchases rising 44% on the year to a monthly average of $64bn.

-***Current account management***. Efforts to contain structural FX outflows by way of higher duties and taxes on gold imports discourage non-essential purchases and production incentives to improve export competitiveness.

IMPACT

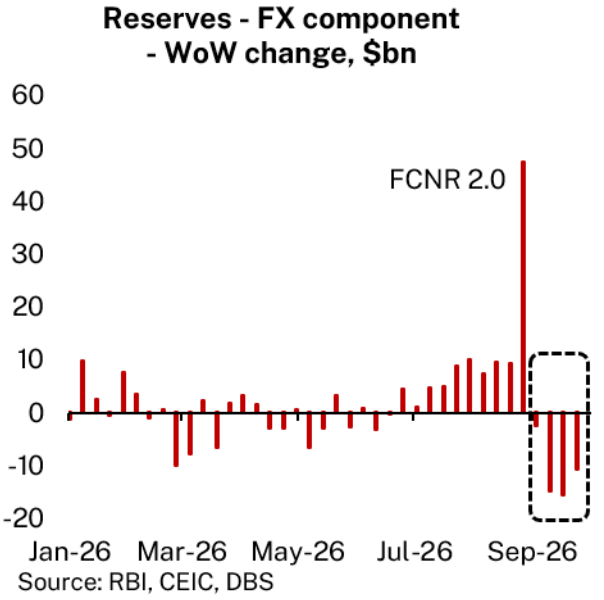
To assess whether the playbook has worked, we observe:

a) Rupee has enjoyed a brief respite. Despite oil prices at $105/bbl at the time of writing and elevated global yields, USDINR fell from near 96.80 towards 95.00, owing to measures announced in Oct26 following the central bank's 25bp hike. Beyond temporary relief, global catalysts are likely to be back to the fore and weigh on the currency (see chart);



Source: Bloomberg, DBS

b) Sharp inflows under the swap facilities pushed the foreign reserves stock to a record high, providing policymakers sufficient buffer to navigate future shocks from a position of strength. A strong interventionist response has since led to a softening in the overall stock (see chart).



Source: RBI, CEIC, DBS

c) Macroprudential measures have led to distortions in other parts of the market. For instance, strong swap-related inflows had inorganically pushed onshore INR liquidity up sharply, necessitating absorption measures. Similarly, NOP restrictions and the more recent tighter requirements on hedging activity and counterparty transactions had some after-effects. Forward points have surged this week, with financial institutions pointing to relative illiquidity in the currency forwards market on volumes and activity basis, and fewer avenues to deal with dollar supply.

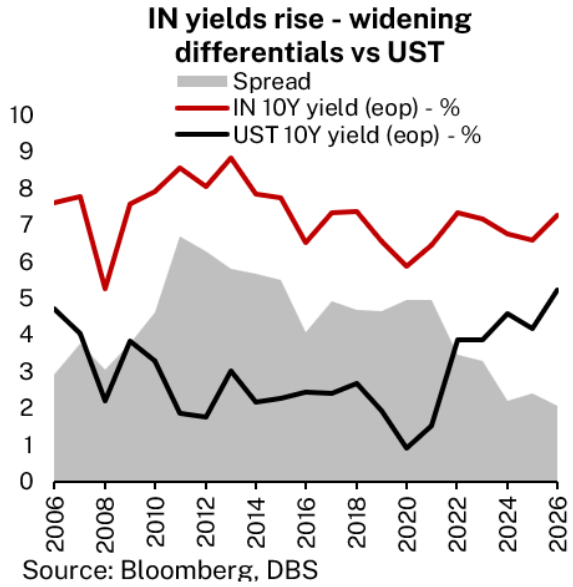


d) Swap-related windows are a timely support for the country's balance of payments position. From expectations of a third consecutive year of BOP deficit in FY27, the math has now swung to a potential surplus, even as current account worries remain. With energy prices settling north of $100/bbl, keeping the monthly trade deficit near $30bn, our FY27 current account deficit forecast of 1.1% of GDP faces upside risks of around 0.3-0.5% of GDP. We note the sharp jump in ECB outflows in Sep, though see that as a temporary overshot of leverage-FCNR activity.

WHAT LIES AHEAD

Authorities are likely not done yet and remain ready to take further action, as required. RBI Governor Malhotra reiterated the authorities' serious intent of stabilising the currency in a recent interview (Moneycontrol, 13 Oct), emphasising that "The RBI is determined to do whatever is necessary to ensure orderly movement in the foreign exchange market,". He also highlighted that recent steps were not tantamount to capital control measures that were aimed at ensuring that forex markets serve genuine hedging needs rather than speculative bets. Market participants opine that FX volumes and interest are likely to be subdued in a few pockets on the back of the recent measures, consequently stabilizing the rupee.

Unlike in 2013, when policy tightening was a part of the initial response, the 2026 strategy has prioritised targeted FX and regulatory measures. The sequencing suggests a deliberate effort to distinguish actions aimed at preserving currency stability from those intended to achieve domestic monetary objectives, with rates remaining a potential, though not immediate, tool in the defence framework.



However, global developments have altered that dynamic. Rising US yields and a gradual increase in the US Fed Funds rate (DBS baseline: a total of 75bp hikes) have compressed IN-US spreads. The recent sell-off in INR benchmark

bonds has effectively widened Gsec-UST spreads across maturities, in contrast to the compression witnessed in regional high-yielders.

The latest announcements may not fully quell speculation over further policy action.

Upcoming measures might include -

-Markets anticipate relief on the long-term capital gains tax structure on equities to draw in longer-duration inflows. This measure will boost inflows if it coincides with other factors that make domestic equities attractive for thematic investing, as global risk-free rates moderate.

-Street expectations also include steps to boost inward dollar repatriation by exporters to boost domestic dollar supply.

-Wider policy rate corridor akin to 2013.

-Policy rate response. While this might not be a panacea, it is a likely necessary condition. Raising the neutral rate might have mixed success in attracting capital market inflows; though rate-sensitive flows are likely to get a fillip as investors seek attractive rate differentials in the region.

An adequate real rate cushion would also align with the evolving domestic inflation realities, which are expected to accelerate to 6% in the Oct-Dec quarter and remain above 5% well into 2027.

Given fluid global developments, we outline three scenarios on the rate path ahead. Our baseline assumption is for 75bp hikes in this cycle (including Oct), spread between the December and February 2027 meetings. **We don't rule out an intermeeting rate hike before the December meeting, contingent on rupee movements.**

Under the second scenario, should depreciation pressures on the rupee return, the 50bp hike might be brought forward to December, with another in February, taking cumulative hikes in this cycle to 100bp. **The third scenario** is a more aggressive 150bp worth of hikes in this cycle, with 50bp front-loaded in December, and the rest spilling into 2027. **Factors that will determine whether these scenarios materialise** are the resumption and scale of rupee depreciation, oil price direction, US Fed Funds rate increases (DBSf: total 75bps) and other risk-off events.

Path ahead

Despite these measures, we see limited room for sustained INR appreciation on grounds of manufacturing/ trade competitiveness. A challenging flows portfolio flows outlook leaves the door open to further gradual rupee depreciation subject to global developments, with high sensitivity to oil price movements and risk sentiments. A strong rate response will help introduce favourable rate differentials and reduce currency volatility.

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The Week Ahead
Forecasts, data preview, central bank watch

16 October 2026

KEY DATA RELEASES AND EVENTS NEXT WEEK

- *PBOC to leave policy unchanged*
- *BI and BoK to pause; BSP to hike*
- *Taiwan's September trade data to underscore AI cycle's strength*



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The Week Ahead covers the key data releases and central bank events of the coming week, collating our macro forecasts.

KEY FORECAST FOR THE COMING WEEK

Event	DBS	Previous
Oct 19 (Mon)		
China: GDP (3Q)	4.3%y/y	4.3% y/y
- retail sales (Sep)	0.3% y/y	0.4% y/y
- industrial production	5.3% y/y	5.2% y/y
- fixed asset investment	-7.5% y/y ytd	-7.2% y/y ytd
Malaysia: CPI (Sep)	2.1% y/y	1.9% y/y
- exports (Sep)	45.0% y/y	45.5% y/y
- imports	44.0% y/y	41.1% y/y
- trade balance	MYR30.9bn	MYR28.1bn
Oct 20 (Tue)		
China: 1Y loan prime rate	3.00%	3.00%
Oct 21 (Wed)		
Indonesia: BI-rate	5.75%	5.75%
Japan: exports (Sep)	24.1% y/y	19.3% y/y
- imports	23.0% y/y	18.0% y/y
- trade balance	JPY27.4bn	-JPY1106bn
Oct 22 (Thu)		
Philippines: BSP overnight borrowing	5.25%	5.00%
South Korea: BOK base rate	3.00%	3.00%
Hong Kong: CPI (Sep)	1.9% y/y	1.7% y/y
Oct 23 (Fri)		
Japan: CPI (Sep)	2.6% y/y	1.9% y/y
Taiwan: industrial production (Sep)	23.5% y/y	23.5% y/y
Singapore: CPI (Sep)	2.4% y/y	2.3% y/y

CENTRAL BANK MEETINGS

People Bank of China (October 20)

We expect the PBOC to keep the 1Y LPR unchanged next week. Industrial production is expected to edge up from 5.2% yoy in August to 5.3% in September, supported by firm external demand. Exports stayed strong, rising 36.3% yoy in September, driven by the regional AI-electronics upcycle.

Domestic momentum, however, remains uneven. Retail sales growth is expected to moderate to 0.3% yoy in September. Household sentiment is weak amid uncertain job prospects, slower income growth and elevated precautionary savings, while subdued property prices continue to weigh on household wealth and consumption. Investment also stays weak, with fixed asset investment expected to contract further by 7.5% yoy ytd in September. Corporate investment is cautious amid the anti-involution campaign and geopolitical tensions, while the property sector continues to be a major drag.

Policymakers are likely to maintain a measured policy stance, relying on targeted fiscal support to sustain growth rather than further rate cuts.

Bank Indonesia and Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas (Oct 21 and 22).

Bank Indonesia is expected to extend its pause, as they lean on non-rate measures, including intervention and hedging facilities to help the currency. On Friday, **MSCI signaled a potential shift in Indonesia's status to a standalone status,** rather than a reclassification to frontier market, after consultations are complete in mid-2027. Any ensuing risk-off move in the currency, would likely prompt greater central bank vigilance and intervention.

Our base case for the benchmark rate to be held unchanged this quarter, backed by a lower conviction around back-to-back US rate hikes in Oct and relative rupiah stability. Separately, the government announced additional support for low-income households in 4Q by way of in-kind assistance and wage subsidies. This year's fiscal deficit is likely to close in at -2.85% of GDP, close to our forecast at -2.9%, but few uncertainties facing the 2027 math (note).

We expect a 25bp hike from the BSP to 5.25% in October, after three rate increases earlier in the year. Rising by the highest pace in Asia, Philippines inflation surged to 7.2% y/y in September from 6.1% in August, matching this year's peak and approaching a three-year high. Inflation risks remain tilted to the upside, driven by further public transport fare adjustments, elevated oil prices, recent wage hikes and peso depreciation. Fiscal space is, meanwhile, limited to support households, via subsidies and/ instate price caps. Governor Remolona also signalled that the BSP remains ready to act on rates to contain inflation. With inflationary pressures likely to be persistent, the likelihood of further hikes in 4Q26 rises.

Bank of Korea (October 22)

The Bank of Korea is expected to hold its policy rate at 3.00%, following back-to-back rate hikes in July and August. AI-driven growth momentum remains strong, as reflected in September export growth of around 80% YoY. However, the urgency for further tightening has eased, with CPI inflation stabilising at 2.9% YoY in September. The recent KOSPI correction and continued KRW strength also reduce the need for another near-term hike. We maintain our call for a final 25bp rate hike in November, bringing the policy rate to 3.25% by year-end.

FORTHCOMING DATA RELEASES

Japan

September trade and CPI data are due shortly. Export growth is expected to remain solid at 24% YoY, supported by continued strength in AI-related semiconductor exports. CPI inflation is projected to rise notably to 2.6% YoY, driven by the phase-out of public utility subsidies, higher global energy prices, and persistent inflationary pressures from a weak yen. The BOJ is likely to increasingly acknowledge that its 2% inflation target is within reach. However, it is expected to keep rates unchanged at 1.25% at its October 29–30 meeting to assess the impact of the latest rate hike in September.

Taiwan

September export orders and industrial production data are due shortly. Export orders are expected to sustain 60% YoY growth, while industrial production is projected to expand by 20% YoY. The global AI boom faces growing headwinds from hyperscalers' cash flow pressures, central bank rate hikes, and higher bond yields. However, our high-frequency indicators across AI demand (token expenditure), investment (hyperscaler capex and data centre construction spending), and supply (semiconductor sales and exports) show no clear signs of a significant slowdown so far.

Malaysia

Malaysia's external demand likely remained strong in September 2026, while inflation edged up slightly. We expect export growth to sustain its robust expansion at 45% yoy, with momentum anchored by strong demand for electrical and electronics goods. Oil & gas shipments likely remained buoyant. However, high base effects prevented a faster pace of expansion.

We expect headline inflation to rise modestly to 2.1% yoy in September 2026. The renewed increase in global oil prices likely contributed to higher increases in domestic energy costs, although fuel subsidies continued to limit the cost pass-through and keep underlying inflationary pressures contained. Food inflation likely also firmed, with adverse weather conditions associated with El Nino posing upside risks.

Singapore

We expect Singapore's core and headline inflation to edge up slightly to 2.3% yoy and 2.4% yoy, respectively, in September 2026, following modest increases to 2.2% yoy and 2.3% yoy in August. Inflationary pressures likely reflected firm private transport price increases amid higher petrol prices despite slower car price growth, the ongoing pass-through of higher global energy prices to fuel-exposed services items, positive contribution from elevated electricity & gas prices, firmer food inflation, and a slight increase in still-muted accommodation inflation. Firm, albeit not accelerating, inflation in September 2026, which may be close to its peak in the Monetary Authority of Singapore's assessment, likely validated its decision to maintain SGD NEER policy settings at the October 2026 review, following two proactive tightening moves in April and July.

Hong Kong

CPI is projected to edge up from 1.7% yoy in August to 1.9% in September, supported by improving consumption sentiment and higher global energy prices. Mainland visitor arrivals increased by 29.0% yoy in September on a daily average basis, providing further support to retail spending and consumer-related services. Meanwhile, renewed conflict in the Middle East during the month has pushed up global energy prices, adding to upward pressure on utility and transport costs.

GROWTH, INFLATION, POLICY RATES & FX FORECASTS

	GDP GROWTH, % YOY				CPI INFLATION, % YOY			
	2025	2026f	2027f	2028f	2025	2026f	2027f	2028f
CHINA	5.0	4.5	4.3	4.0	0.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
HONG KONG	3.5	3.8	2.8	2.5	1.4	2.0	2.0	2.0
INDIA	7.3	7.8	7.0	6.8	2.2	4.6	5.0	4.2
*INDIA (FISCAL YEAR) **	*7.8*	*7.3*	*7.0*	*6.8*	*2.1*	*5.3*	*4.7*	4.5
INDONESIA	5.1	5.3	5.2	5.2	1.9	3.3	2.5	2.2
MALAYSIA	5.2	5.2	4.5	4.3	1.4	2.0	2.0	2.0
PHILIPPINES**	4.5	3.0	4.0	4.5	1.7	6.5	5.5	3.5
SINGAPORE	5.0	5.7	3.5	2.8	0.9	2.0	1.8	1.6
SOUTH KOREA	1.0	3.5	2.4	2.0	2.1	2.6	2.7	2.7
TAIWAN	8.8	11.6	5.6	3.8	1.7	2.0	2.1	1.9
THAILAND	2.4	2.1	2.0	2.2	-0.1	1.7	1.0	1.2
VIETNAM	8.0	9.1	8.0	7.2	3.3	4.8	3.3	3.0
EUROZONE	1.5	1.2	1.2	0.9	2.2	3.1	2.1	2.0
JAPAN	1.2	0.9	1.0	0.9	3.2	1.8	1.5	2.0
UNITED STATES***	2.1	2.3	2.2	2.0	2.7	3.3	2.8	2.4

** 2020 = Fiscal year Apr20-Mar21 ** new CPI series *** eop for CPI inflation*

POLICY INTEREST RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
CHINA*	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
INDIA	5.25	5.25	5.25	5.75	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00
INDONESIA	4.75	5.75	5.75	5.75	5.75	5.75	5.75	5.75
MALAYSIA	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
PHILIPPINES	4.25	4.75	5.00	5.50	5.50	5.50	5.50	5.50
SINGAPORE**	1.16	1.16	1.60	1.80	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00
SOUTH KOREA	2.50	2.50	3.00	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25	3.25
TAIWAN	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13
THAILAND	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
VIETNAM***	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50
EUROZONE^	2.00	2.25	2.50	2.75	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
JAPAN	0.75	1.00	1.25	1.25	1.50	1.75	1.75	1.75
UNITED STATES	3.75	3.75	4.00	4.25	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50

** 1-yr Loan Prime Rate; ** 3M SORA OIS ; *** refinancing rate; ^ deposit facility rate*

EXCHANGE RATES, EOP

	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
USD/CNY	6.89	6.79	6.69	6.60	6.63	6.65	6.68	6.70
USD/HKD	7.84	7.84	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83	7.83
USD/INR	94.8	94.7	95.8	95.6	95.7	95.8	95.9	96.0
USD/IDR	17041	17907	17720	17400	17470	17530	17600	17660
USD/MYR	4.05	4.08	4.07	4.00	4.04	4.08	4.11	4.15
USD/PHP	60.7	61.3	62.6	61.5	62.1	62.8	63.4	64.0
USD/SGD	1.29	1.29	1.28	1.26	1.27	1.27	1.28	1.29
USD/KRW	1516	1549	1395	1400	1410	1420	1425	1435
USD/THB	32.6	33.2	33.3	32.6	32.8	32.9	33.0	33.2
USD/VND	26340	26310	26000	25840	25980	26120	26260	26400
AUD/USD	0.69	0.69	0.71	0.71	0.71	0.70	0.70	0.70
EUR/USD	1.16	1.14	1.15	1.18	1.17	1.17	1.16	1.15
USD/JPY	159	163	156	151	153	154	155	157
GBP/USD	1.32	1.33	1.34	1.36	1.35	1.34	1.33	1.32

INTEREST RATE FORECASTS

		2026				2027			
		Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
US	3M SOFR OIS	3.68	3.75	3.90	4.15	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.40
	2Y	3.79	4.16	4.60	4.65	4.70	4.70	4.70	4.70
	10Y	4.32	4.45	5.00	5.10	5.20	5.20	5.20	5.20
	10Y-2Y	52	29	40	45	50	50	50	50
Japan	3M TIBOR	1.27	1.41	1.50	1.60	1.75	1.85	1.85	1.85
	2Y	1.35	1.39	1.60	1.70	1.85	1.95	1.95	1.95
	10Y	2.35	2.72	2.80	2.85	2.95	3.00	3.00	3.00
	10Y-2Y	100	133	120	115	110	105	105	105
Eurozone	3M EURIBOR	2.08	2.32	2.70	2.95	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20
	2Y	2.62	2.53	3.21	3.00	3.20	3.20	3.20	3.20
	10Y	3.00	2.86	3.59	3.40	3.50	3.60	3.70	3.80
	10Y-2Y	39	33	38	40	30	40	50	60
Indonesia	IDR 3M OIS	4.12	6.45	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90	5.90
	2Y	6.31	7.21	6.90	6.80	6.70	6.65	6.60	6.50
	10Y	6.86	7.16	7.00	6.95	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90
	10Y-2Y	55	-5	10	15	20	25	30	40
Malaysia	3M KLIBOR	3.37	3.45	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35
	3Y	3.26	3.26	3.35	3.30	3.30	3.25	3.25	3.25
	10Y	3.63	3.60	3.80	3.85	3.85	3.85	3.80	3.80
	10Y-3Y	37	35	45	55	55	60	55	55
Philippines	3M NDF implied yield	6.09	4.94	5.55	6.05	6.05	6.05	6.05	6.05
	2Y	5.42	6.08	6.20	6.25	6.25	6.30	6.35	6.35
	10Y	6.98	6.90	7.35	7.45	7.50	7.55	7.60	7.65
	10Y-2Y	156	82	115	120	125	125	125	130
Singapore	3M SORA OIS	1.16	1.16	1.60	1.80	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00
	2Y	1.61	1.58	1.95	2.10	2.20	2.20	2.20	2.20
	10Y	2.29	2.04	2.50	2.60	2.70	2.70	2.70	2.70
	10Y-2Y	68	45	55	50	50	50	50	50
Thailand	3M BIBOR	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15	1.15
	2Y	1.41	1.14	1.15	1.20	1.25	1.30	1.35	1.35
	10Y	2.23	2.04	2.10	2.20	2.30	2.40	2.50	2.60
	10Y-2Y	82	90	95	100	105	110	115	125
China	1Y LPR	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00
	2Y	1.37	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25	1.25
	10Y	1.86	1.73	1.75	1.80	1.80	1.85	1.85	1.85
	10Y-2Y	48	48	50	55	55	60	60	60
Hong Kong, SAR	3M HIBOR	2.36	2.97	3.10	3.35	3.60	3.60	3.60	3.60
	2Y*	2.82	3.43	3.90	3.95	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00
	10Y*	3.08	3.45	4.20	4.30	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.40
	10Y-2Y	26	2	30	35	40	40	40	40
Korea	3M CD	2.82	2.92	3.25	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.50
	3Y	3.56	3.70	3.75	3.90	3.90	3.90	3.90	3.90
	10Y	3.88	4.07	4.20	4.35	4.35	4.35	4.35	4.35
	10Y-3Y	32	37	45	45	45	45	45	45
India	3M MIBOR	7.25	6.61	6.30	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90	6.90
	2Y	6.37	5.99	6.54	6.95	7.15	7.15	7.15	7.15
	10Y	7.04	6.75	7.19	7.45	7.60	7.60	7.60	7.60
	10Y-2Y	67	76	65	50	45	45	45	45

%, eop, govt bond yield for 2Y and 10Y, spread bps
Sources: Data for all charts and tables are from CEIC, Bloomberg and DBS Group Research (forecasts and transformations)

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DBS Focus

Taiwan: AI, energy and 4Q outlook

13 October 2026



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- *The global landscape remains complex, shaped by AI, energy prices and tariffs.*
- *Taiwan's AI cycle remains strong, with robust AI exports and investment and an intact semiconductor competitive moat.*
- *AI is generating broader domestic spillovers, with wealth effects and wage growth supporting consumption.*
- *Taiwan is cushioning the energy shock by diversifying energy imports and absorbing much of the increase in upstream costs.*
- *AI-driven growth is likely to moderate from 4Q26 into 2027, as hyperscaler cash-flow pressures rise and higher global rates lift investment costs.*
- *Energy remains an inflation risk, with domestic electricity prices facing upward pressure after the November local elections.*
- *GDP growth is expected to moderate to high-single digits from 4Q26, while we maintain our 11.6%/5.6% GDP forecasts for 2026/27.*
- *Inflation is likely to remain above 2% in 4Q26, with our 2.0%/2.1% CPI forecasts for 2026/27 unchanged.*
- *We maintain our call for CBC to hike 12.5bp to 2.125% in December, amid tighter liquidity conditions.*
- *Housing should recover gradually despite credit easing, as excess new-home inventory remains an overhang.*

Global backdrop

The global landscape remains complex, shaped by the interplay of AI, energy prices and tariffs, with significant implications for growth, inflation and financial conditions.

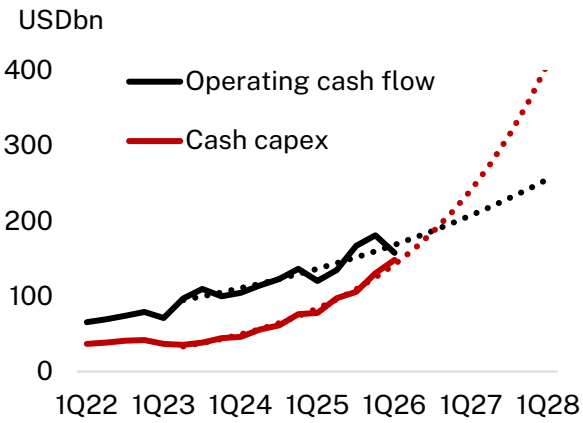
1) AI

The debate over the durability of the AI investment boom continues. Tailwinds include technological advances, broader adoption, and strategic and geopolitical considerations. Headwinds range from uncertainty over investment returns and hyperscaler financing pressure to physical bottlenecks, safety concerns, and regulatory uncertainty.

Hyperscaler financing pressure has attracted increasing attention. In the early stages of the AI investment boom, hyperscaler capex was largely financed by internal cash flow. This is now changing, as free cash flow is expected to turn negative from 4Q, requiring major players to rely on debt issuance and other external financing increasingly.

At the same time, higher global interest rates are raising the cost of AI investment. The Fed resumed rate hikes at its September meeting, while global bond yields remain under upward pressure amid persistent inflation and elevated public and private borrowing needs. Our baseline assumes US rates will rise by 50bps this year and a further 25bps in 2027 to 4.50%, with global long-term rates also remaining under pressure. This could increasingly weigh on the economics and pace of AI investment.

Hyperscaler cash flow vs. capex

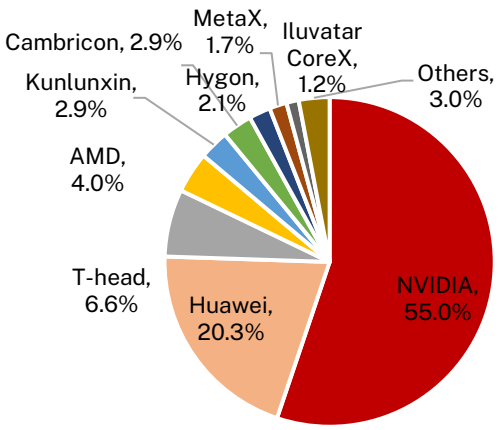


Sources: EPOCH AI, DBS
Notes: Hyperscalers include Microsoft, Amazon, Alphabet, Meta, and Oracle

US-China AI competition is also drawing increasing attention. Across the five layers of the AI ecosystem, China is making rapid progress in energy, infrastructure, AI models and applications, supported by its large scale, cost-effective domestic manufacturing supply chains and huge consumer market, which provides a wide range of real-world scenarios for AI adoption. The emergence of a more integrated and cost-competitive Chinese AI ecosystem could increasingly challenge the US ecosystem, which currently operates at a relatively higher cost.

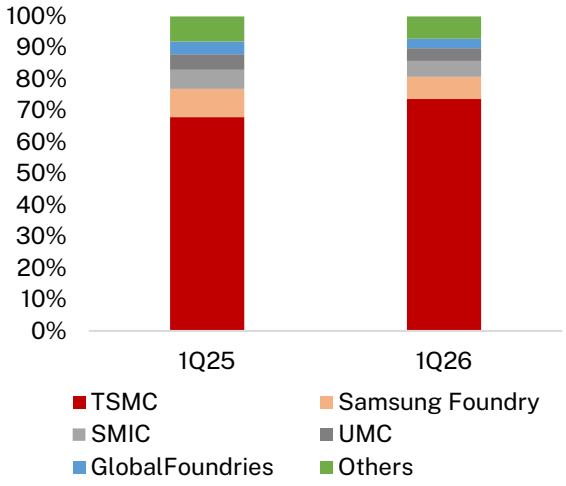
China, however, remains relatively weak in semiconductors. Around half of China's domestic AI chip market still relies on foreign suppliers, including lower-end NVIDIA chips. This semiconductor bottleneck remains a key constraint on China's AI development. In our view, Taiwanese semiconductor companies' competitive moat therefore remains largely intact in the near term.

China's AI chip market share, 2025



Sources: Trendforce, DBS

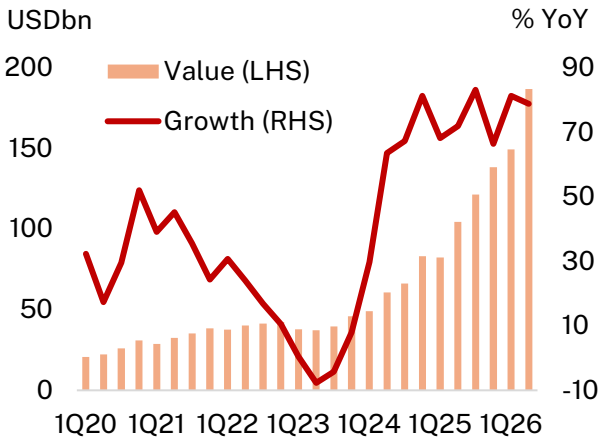
Global pure foundry market share



Sources: Counterpoint, DBS

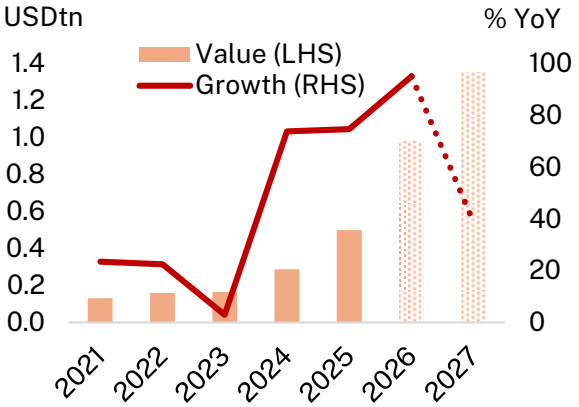
So far, there is limited evidence of a significant slowdown in AI investment or semiconductor demand. Hyperscaler capex maintained robust yoy growth through 2Q, while Bloomberg forecasts growth to moderate from 95% this year to 39% in 2027. Similarly, global semiconductor sales remained strong through 3Q, while WSTS expects growth to moderate from 90% this year to 27% in 2027.

Hyperscaler capex



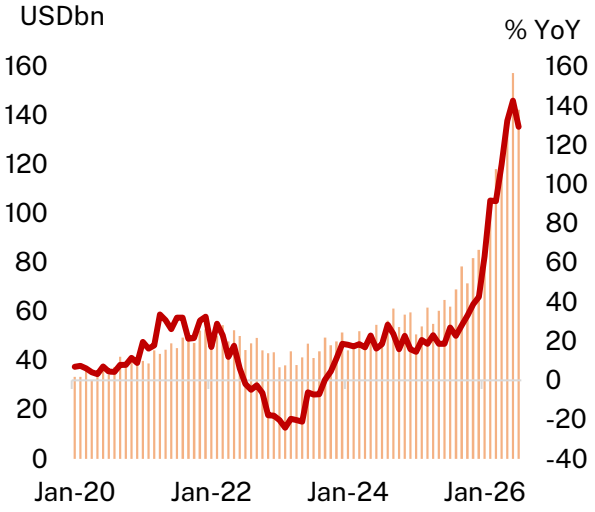
Sources: Bloomberg, DBS
Notes: Hyperscalers include Microsoft, Amazon, Alphabet, Meta, and Oracle

Hyperscaler capex forecast



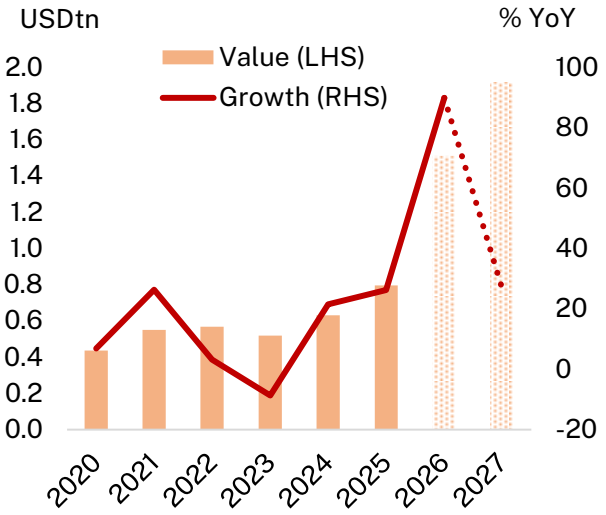
Sources: Bloomberg, DBS
Notes: Hyperscalers include Microsoft, Amazon, Alphabet, Meta, Oracle, Tier 2/Neoclouds, and Chinese players.

Global semiconductor sales



Sources: WSTS, DBS

Global semiconductor sales forecast



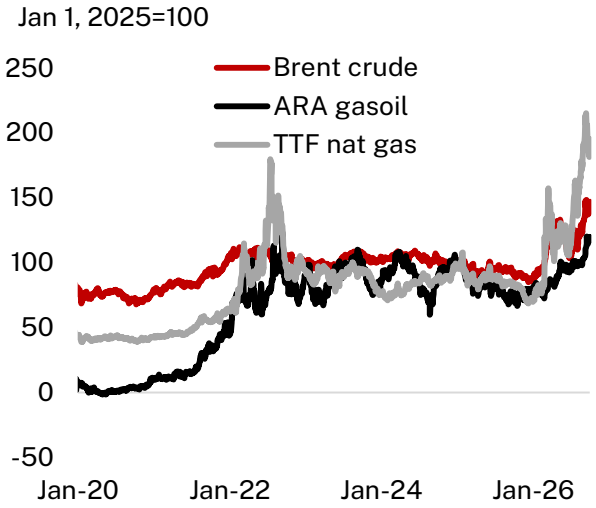
Sources: WSTS, DBS

2) Energy

The US-Iran conflict remains at a standoff, keeping the energy-price outlook highly uncertain. New developments are likely after the US midterm elections in November, with both further escalation and de-escalation possible. Crude oil prices have remained elevated at around USD100/bbl amid a persistent geopolitical risk premium. In contrast, refined product prices have risen more sharply as refining disruptions and tighter product logistics have amplified the supply shock. Natural gas prices have also increased sharply, reflecting disruptions to LNG supply and limited alternative shipping routes.

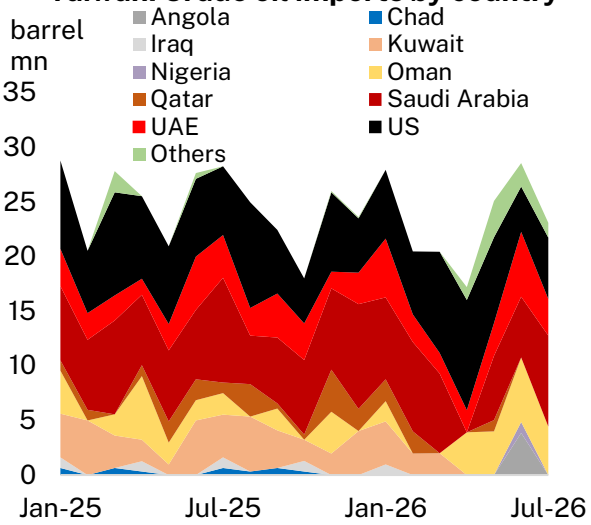
Taiwan has been actively diversifying its energy import sources to cushion the impact. LNG imports from Qatar have fallen to zero since April, while imports from the US and other suppliers have surged to offset the shortfall, helping maintain stable domestic electricity supply.

ICE energy prices



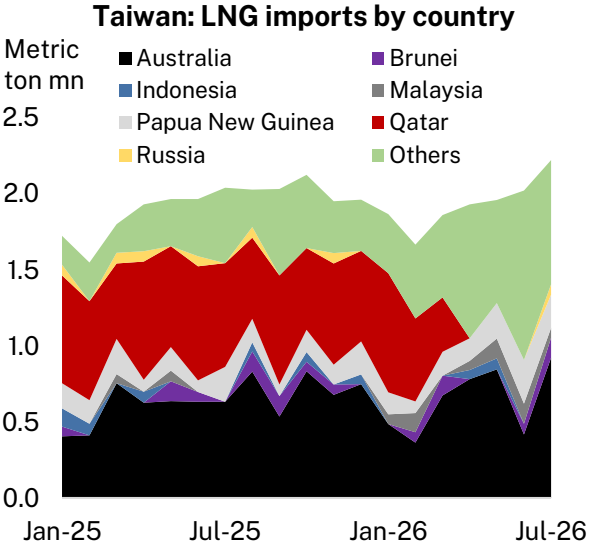
Sources: Bloomberg, DBS

Taiwan: Crude oil imports by country



Sources: CEIC, DBS

Taiwan: LNG imports by country



Sources: CEIC, DBS

3) Tariffs

US tariff actions are likely to accelerate after the US midterm elections in November. Two major tariff measures remain in the pipeline. The Section 301 forced-labor tariff was implemented in July, while final tariff action under the Section 301 overcapacity investigation, which covers 16 economies, remains pending. Meanwhile, Phase 1 of the Section 232 semiconductor tariffs was implemented in January, while Phase 2, covering a broader range of semiconductor-related products, remains pending.

Taiwan has secured a relatively favourable framework through its trade and investment agreements with the US. Taiwan signed an Agreement on Reciprocal Trade (ART) and an Investment MOU with the US earlier this year. The ART establishes a 15% US tariff rate on Taiwanese goods, while the MOU provides Taiwan with preferential treatment under Section 232, including for semiconductors. The ART has yet to enter into force, and it remains to be seen how the final Section 301 tariff burden will interact with the 15% ART framework. Meanwhile, major Taiwanese companies such as TSMC are expanding their US investments under the Investment MOU, which could support relatively favourable treatment for Taiwan when broader Section 232 semiconductor tariffs are introduced.

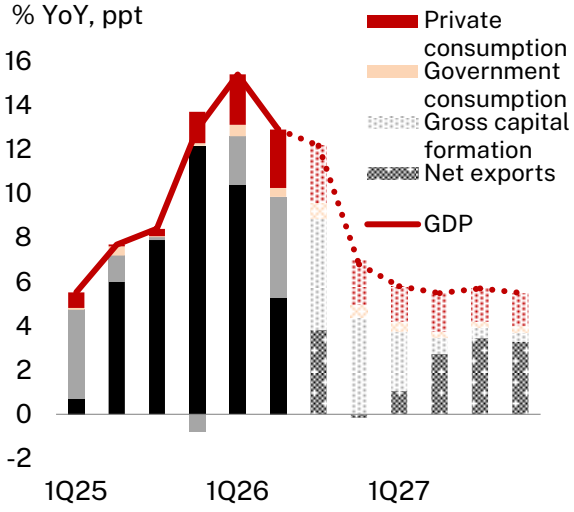
Taiwan 4Q outlook

Taiwan has navigated the complex global environment relatively well so far this year, supported by robust AI exports and investment, diversified energy imports, and efforts to absorb higher upstream energy costs. Some normalisation is likely in 4Q26–2027, as the AI-driven growth boost moderates and domestic energy prices face greater pressure to adjust.

1) Growth

GDP growth remains broadly on track with our expectations. High-frequency indicators suggest that GDP growth should remain around 12% yoy in 3Q, broadly in line with 12.9% in 2Q but below the 15.4% peak in 1Q. Growth is expected to moderate to a high-single-digit pace from 4Q onwards. **We maintain our full-year GDP growth forecasts at 11.6% for 2026 and 5.6% for 2027.**

Taiwan: GDP growth forecast



Sources: CEIC, DBS

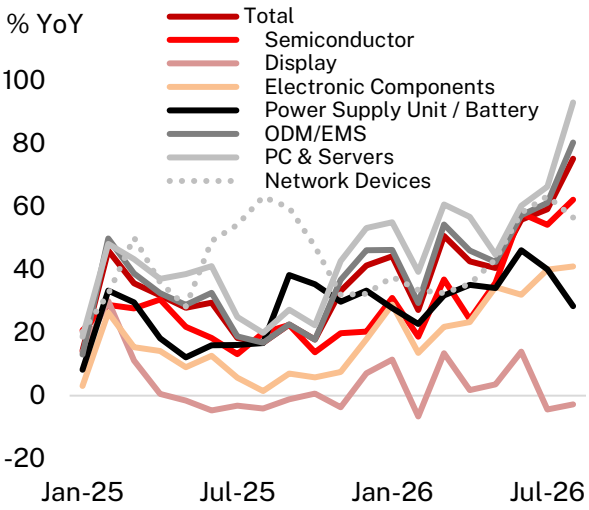
The AI cycle remains the key driver of Taiwan's growth. Information and communication products and electronic components accounted for nearly 80% of total exports in the first nine months of this year, while manufacturing accounts for nearly 50% of gross fixed

capital formation. From 4Q onwards, export growth is expected to moderate from exceptionally strong levels to a more normal but still robust pace, broadly following the trajectory of global hyperscaler capex and semiconductor sales. Investment is likely to follow a similar path.

For now, Taiwanese technology companies continue to report robust revenue growth, led by semiconductors, ODMs/EMS, and PCs and servers. Capacity utilisation at leading Taiwanese foundries has also continued to rise, suggesting that investment demand remains strong.

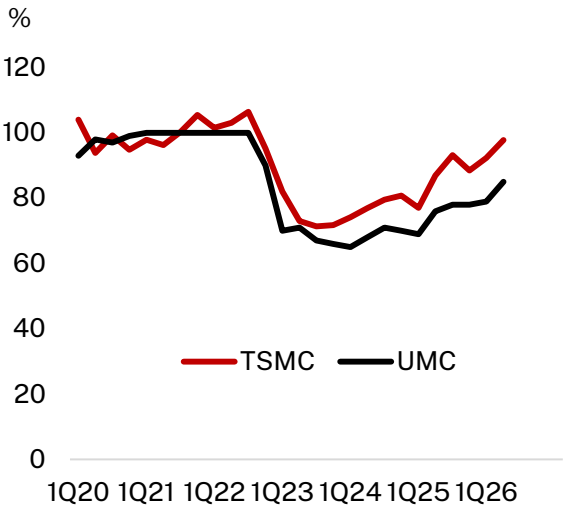
The AI boom is also beginning to generate broader spillovers to the domestic economy. The AI-driven equity rally has generated significant wealth effects, with the TAIEX up 70% year-to-date and Taiwan becoming the world's fifth-largest stock market. Taiwanese households have benefited from the appreciation of financial assets, with equities and mutual funds accounting for nearly 30% of total household financial assets. The equity rally has also generated positive income effects. Wage growth has picked up, led by the services sector, particularly financial services, as strong earnings at financial institutions — especially securities firms — have prompted higher compensation to retain talent. These wealth and income gains should support household consumption, creating a positive feedback loop that broadens the benefits of the AI boom across the wider economy.

Taiwan: Tech sector revenue



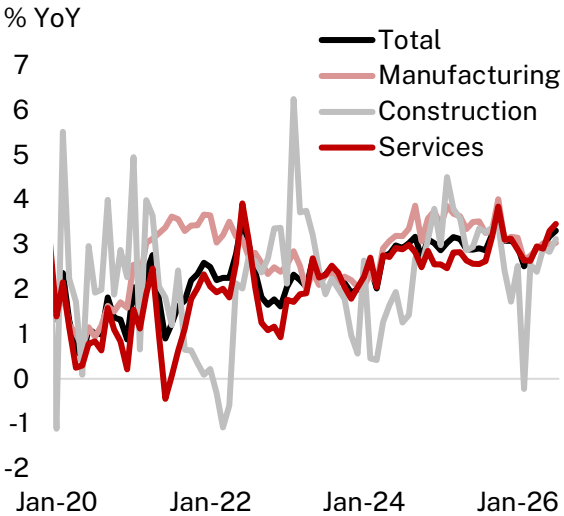
Sources: Bloomberg, DBS

Taiwan: Foundry capacity utilization



Sources: Bloomberg, DBS

Taiwan: Base wage growth by sector

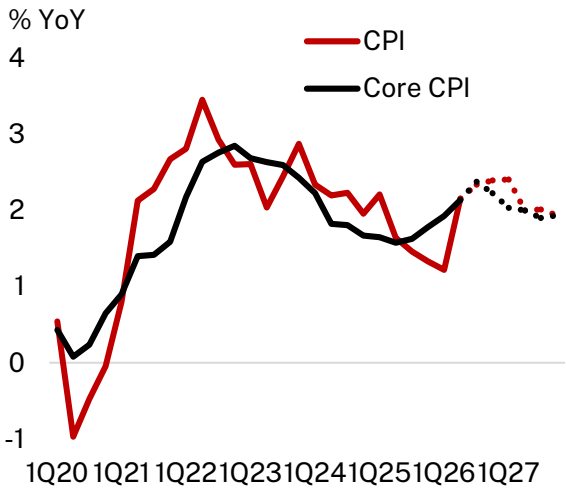


Sources: CEIC, DBS

2) Inflation

CPI inflation is also tracking broadly in line with our forecast. Headline CPI remained elevated at 2.4% yoy in 3Q, up from 1.2% in 1Q and 2.2% in 2Q. **We maintain our forecast for headline CPI inflation to remain close to 2.5% in 4Q, and retain our full-year forecasts at 2.0% for 2026 and 2.1% for 2027.**

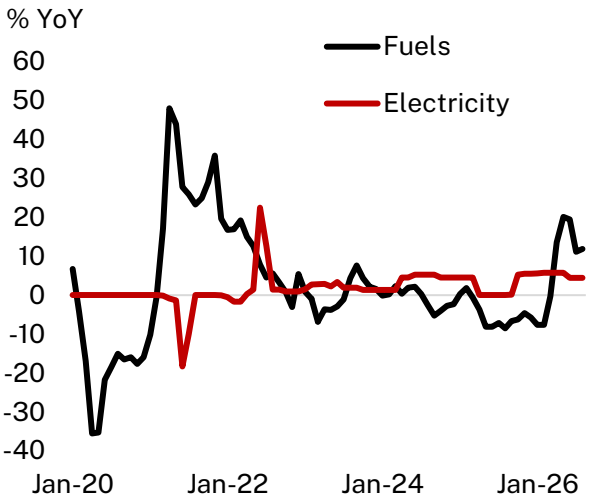
Taiwan: CPI inflation forecast



Sources: CEIC, DBS

Energy inflation remains the main upside risk. The government has absorbed much of the increase in energy costs through state-owned CPC and Taipower, limiting the pass-through to domestic consumers. With losses at both companies widening, the government will need to decide whether to provide additional subsidies to cover the losses or allow further increases in domestic energy prices. The September review postponed the adjustment to the December meeting, when the overall situation will be reassessed after the November local elections. Taipower's latest review indicated that electricity rates would need to rise by 12.8%. A hike in electricity prices could lift inflation expectations and generate second-round effects, particularly as the labour market tightens and wage pressures increase.

Taiwan: CPI - energy prices



Sources: CEIC, DBS

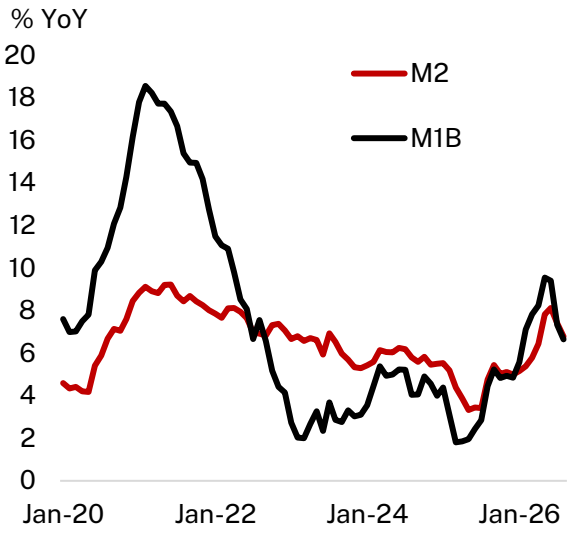
3) Monetary policy

The central bank kept the policy discount rate unchanged at 2.00% at its September meeting, in line with our expectations. **We continue to expect a modest 12.5bp rate hike at the December meeting, bringing the policy rate to 2.125%.** By then, CPI inflation is likely to have remained above 2% for around six consecutive months. The possibility of an increase in electricity prices following the November local elections could further lift inflation expectations, strengthening the case for a December rate hike.

Financial conditions have already tightened despite the absence of a policy rate hike. M2 growth remained around 7% yoy in 3Q, well below double-digit nominal GDP growth. At the same time, bank loan growth has accelerated to more than 10% yoy, driven by strong

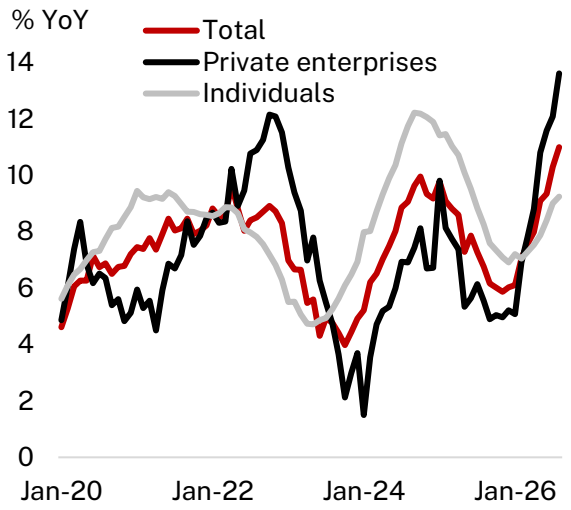
corporate credit demand, particularly AI-related fundraising by technology companies. Tighter financial conditions are also evident in rising market interest rates, including commercial paper rates and government bond yields.

Taiwan: Money supply



Sources: CEIC, DBS

Taiwan: Bank loans



Sources: CEIC, DBS

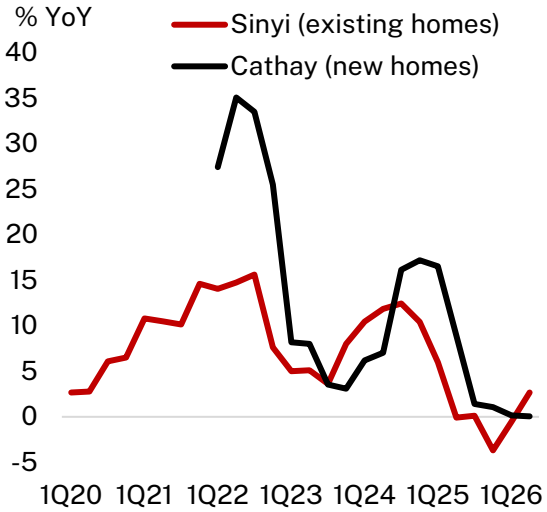
The central bank has continued to ease housing credit controls gradually. At its September meeting, it raised the LTV cap on second-home mortgage loans to 70%, the second easing of housing credit controls this year. There is scope for further easing, including removing the LTV cap on second-home loans or raising the LTV caps for third- and fourth-home loans and high-value properties, which currently stand at 30%. However, the central bank is likely to proceed cautiously, given concerns that a faster relaxation could reignite speculative demand and put renewed upward pressure on housing prices.

4) Housing

A gradual and modest recovery in the housing market is expected from 4Q26 into 2027. The existing-home market has already shown early signs of recovery, with Sinyi housing prices returning to slightly positive yoy growth since 2Q. Total building transactions also returned to positive yoy growth in 3Q. The easing of credit controls should help reinforce this modest recovery trend.

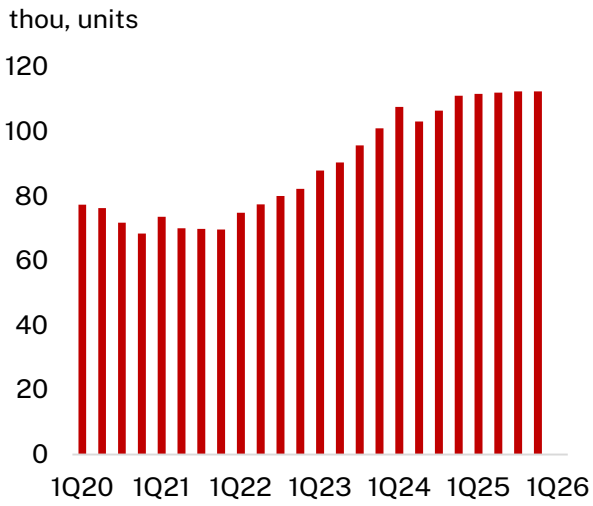
The new-home market remains under pressure. The number of new units under construction has started to decline since 2023, while new completions are only beginning to ease this year. Demand remains weak, as potential buyers continue to wait for lower prices. Unsold new homes stood at 113K units at end-2025, compared with a historical normal level of around 80K, implying excess inventory of roughly 30K units. At the current pace of new-home transactions, it would take roughly one year to normalize the existing excess inventory, and longer when factoring in the new supply pipeline. Some industry experts estimate that it could take as long as 3.8 years digest current inventories fully (here).

Taiwan: Residential property prices



Sources: CEIC, DBS

Taiwan: Unsold new homes



Sources: Ministry of the Interior, DBS

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